

# Unit 4 - Social Media Marketing

Digital Marketing (DI03016011) - GTU Diploma IT Sem 3

**18% weightage | 5 hours**

**How to use these notes:** each topic is written the way you can copy it in the exam. **3 marks** = definition + 2-3 points. **4 marks** = add example or table. **7 marks** = write everything, with diagram/table and a real example. Lines marked ★ show where the topic was asked in a GTU paper (only 2 papers exist: Winter 2025 and Summer 2026).

## Questions already asked from this unit (do these first)

- W2025 Q4(c)OR [7M: social media marketing strategy for a sustainable clothing line] (similar S2026 Q5(b)OR)
- S2026 Q5(b)OR [4M: social media strategy outline for a new fashion business]
- W2025 Q4(b) [4M: list types of Meta ads, describe two use cases]
- S2026 Q4(b) [4M: three Instagram Insights metrics for a fashion store]
- S2026 Q4(c)OR [7M: functions of Facebook Page, Business Manager and Facebook Ads, how they help]
- S2026 Q4(c) [7M: Dynamic Ads concept + LinkedIn personalisation example]
- S2026 Q5(b) [4M: concept of Twitter marketing]
- W2025 Q4(a)OR [3M: promoted tweets, promoted accounts, promoted trends]
- W2025 Q4(c) [7M: choose a brand, how it uses video marketing for a new product, at least two video formats]
- W2025 Q4(b)OR [4M: how video content enhances engagement on social platforms]

## 4.1 Social media marketing: importance, types, strategy

**Social media marketing (SMM)** = promoting a brand, product or service on social media platforms (Facebook, Instagram, X, LinkedIn, YouTube) to build awareness, engage people and drive sales.

### Importance and benefits

- Brand awareness and wide reach, low cost, highly **targeted** advertising.
- Direct engagement and customer service; builds community and loyalty.
- Drives website traffic and leads; real-time feedback; analytics / insights.

### Types of social media marketing / platforms

| Type                            | Examples                     |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------|
| Social networking               | Facebook, LinkedIn           |
| Media / photo and video sharing | Instagram, YouTube, Snapchat |
| Microblogging                   | X (Twitter), Threads         |
| Discussion / forums             | Reddit, Quora                |
| Messaging                       | WhatsApp, Telegram           |
| Visual discovery / bookmarking  | Pinterest                    |

### Building a better social media strategy

1. Set clear goals (awareness, leads, sales).
2. Know the target audience.
3. Choose the right platforms.
4. Plan content (mix of videos, images, stories, offers) and a posting calendar.
5. Engage: reply to comments, polls, contests, user-generated content.
6. Use paid ads to boost reach.
7. Measure with insights and improve.

#### 4.1 Strategy: sustainable clothing line

★ W2025 Q4(c)OR [7M: social media marketing strategy for a sustainable clothing line] (similar S2026 Q5(b)OR)

**Business:** 'EcoThread' - sustainable clothing made from organic cotton and recycled fabric.

**Target audience:** eco-conscious students and young professionals, age 18-35.

##### 1. Goals

Brand awareness, 5,000 followers and 100 online orders in 3 months.

##### 2. Platform choice

| Platform                                     | Why                                                           |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Instagram</b> (Reels, Stories, carousels) | Main platform for fashion and young audience; visual shopping |
| <b>YouTube / Shorts</b>                      | Behind-the-scenes, fabric-making and styling videos           |
| <b>Pinterest</b>                             | Outfit inspiration, drives website traffic                    |
| <b>Facebook</b> and <b>LinkedIn</b>          | Community and ads; LinkedIn for corporate / uniform orders    |

##### 3. Content ideas

- **Behind-the-scenes** of organic cotton farming and factory.
- **Reels:** 'How a T-shirt is made from plastic bottles', 30-wear challenge, styling one shirt 5 ways.
- **Carousel / infographics:** 'Water saved by one organic shirt'.
- **User-generated content** with #WearTheChange; customer testimonial videos.
- Influencer collaborations with eco-lifestyle creators; polls, quizzes, Q&A, giveaways.

##### 4. Engagement tactics and ads

- Reply to every comment / DM; weekly live Q&A.
- Run Meta carousel and lead ads to the target group; retarget website visitors.
- Offer first-order discount to followers.

##### 5. Measure

Instagram Insights (reach, engagement, saves), website clicks, conversions and cost per order; improve monthly.

#### 4.1 Strategy: new fashion business (short)

★ S2026 Q5(b)OR [4M: social media strategy outline for a new fashion business]

- **Platforms:** **Instagram** (Reels, Stories, shopping tags) for visuals and young buyers; **Pinterest** for inspiration and traffic; **Facebook** for ads and community; **YouTube Shorts** for styling videos.
- **Content ideas:** new-collection reels, 'style one outfit 3 ways', behind-the-scenes of design, customer photos (UGC), festival lookbooks, short reviews and sale announcements.
- **Engagement tactics:** reply to comments and DMs, polls and quizzes in Stories, giveaways, influencer collaborations, hashtag campaign, live Q&A with the designer.
- **Paid and measure:** Meta ads (carousel / lead ads) to target audience; use Insights to track reach, engagement and sales.

## 4.2 Meta ads types

★ W2025 Q4(b) [4M: list types of Meta ads, describe two use cases]

**Meta** (Facebook, Instagram, Messenger) offers these ad types (syllabus):

| Ad type                    | What it is                                                                    | Use case                                                                   |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Carousel ads</b>        | 2-10 scrollable images / videos, each with its own link                       | Fashion store shows 5 dresses in one ad; real-estate shows different flats |
| <b>Story ads</b>           | Full-screen vertical (9:16) ads between Facebook / Instagram Stories          | Flash sale or festival offer with 'Swipe up / Shop now'                    |
| <b>Lead generation ads</b> | Ad with an in-app form to collect name, email, phone without leaving Facebook | Coaching class collects enquiries; free demo or newsletter sign-up         |
| <b>Video ads</b>           | Video in feed, stories or Reels                                               | Product demo or brand story to raise awareness                             |

Others: image ads, collection ads, dynamic (catalogue) ads. Ads are created in **Meta Ads Manager**.

## 4.2 Insights in Meta Business Suite

★ S2026 Q4(b) [4M: three Instagram Insights metrics for a fashion store]

**Insights** (in **Meta Business Suite** / Instagram professional dashboard) show how content and audience perform. Three essential metrics for a fashion retail store:

1. **Reach and impressions:** number of unique accounts that saw the post (reach) and total views (impressions) - shows brand visibility of new collections.
2. **Engagement (likes, comments, shares, saves):** shows which posts / Reels people like. High **saves and shares** = interested in the product.
3. **Profile visits and website / link clicks:** shows interest and traffic leading to the online store - closer to sales.

Also useful: follower growth, audience demographics (age, gender, city), best times to post, Reels watch time. Use them to repeat what works.

## 4.2 Facebook Page, Business Manager and Ads

★ S2026 Q4(c)OR [7M: functions of Facebook Page, Business Manager and Facebook Ads, how they help]

| Asset                                             | Main functions                                                                                                                                                                       | How it helps the business                                                                                  |
|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Facebook Page</b>                              | Public business profile: posts, photos, videos, about info, contact, reviews and ratings, messages (Messenger), shop / call-to-action button, events                                 | Online identity, builds community and trust, direct customer communication and support, free organic reach |
| <b>Business Manager</b> (now Meta Business Suite) | One central place to manage <b>Pages, ad accounts, Instagram accounts, pixels</b> ; give roles and permissions to team / agencies; billing; insights; schedule posts                 | Safe, organised control of all assets; many people can work without sharing passwords; combined reporting  |
| <b>Facebook Ads</b> (Ads Manager)                 | Create campaigns with objective (awareness, traffic, leads, sales), <b>targeting</b> (age, location, interests), budget, placements (Facebook, Instagram), ad formats; track results | Reaches the exact audience, quick customers / leads, measurable ROI, retargeting                           |

**Together:** the Page builds presence → Business Manager organises and secures it → Ads Manager promotes it and measures results. *Example:* a local bakery builds a Page with menu and reviews, adds the team in Business Manager, and runs a ₹200/day ad for 'birthday cakes' to people within 10 km.

## 4.2 Dynamic ads (LinkedIn)

★ S2026 Q4(c) [7M: Dynamic Ads concept + LinkedIn personalisation example]

**Dynamic ads** are ads whose content is **generated and personalised automatically** for each viewer using data (profile details, browsing behaviour, product catalogue). One ad template shows **different text / images to different people**.

### Key points

- Created from a **template + data feed**, so thousands of variations are made automatically.
- Saves time and gives **higher relevance, CTR and conversions**.
- Common on Meta (catalogue ads that show products you viewed), Google and LinkedIn.

### LinkedIn dynamic ads

LinkedIn dynamic ads personalise the creative with the viewer's **LinkedIn profile data** - such as **name, profile photo, job title, company** - in a professional audience. (Formats include follower ads, spotlight ads and content / job ads.)

**Example:** A software-training company runs an ad: 'Hi Priya, upskill as a Data Analyst - Python course for professionals at Infosys. Enroll now', showing her name, photo and company. A different viewer sees his own name and company. Another example: a job-ad that shows 'Jobs at [Company] matching your skills'.

**Benefits:** personal feel → more attention, better engagement, better leads; no manual work for each audience.

## 4.3 Twitter (X) for business

★ S2026 Q5(b) [4M: concept of Twitter marketing]

★ W2025 Q4(a)OR [3M: promoted tweets, promoted accounts, promoted trends]

**Twitter (X) marketing** means using the microblogging platform X (formerly Twitter; 'tweets' are now called posts) to promote a brand through short messages, conversations and ads, mainly for **real-time engagement**.

- **Hashtags (#):** group posts by topic, increase reach and join trends / campaigns. Use 1-2 relevant hashtags.
- **Customer service:** reply to complaints and questions publicly or by DM - quick response builds trust.
- **Live tweets:** share live updates from events, launches, Q&A sessions.

- **Content:** news, offers, polls, images, short videos; engage by replying and retweeting.
- **Advertising:** promoted tweets, promoted accounts, promoted trends.
- **Analytics** to track impressions, engagement, followers.
- **Promoted tweets:** ordinary tweets that a brand **pays** to show to a wider / targeted audience in timelines and search results; labelled 'Promoted'. Aim: reach, clicks, engagement.
- **Promoted accounts:** the brand's account is suggested in 'Who to follow' and timelines to gain **more followers**.
- **Promoted trends:** a brand's **hashtag / topic is placed at the top of the Trending list** for a day, giving massive visibility (used for big launches).

#### 4.4 Video marketing: types and best practices

| Video type        | Purpose                                                             |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Explainer video   | Short video explaining a product or idea simply                     |
| Educational video | Teaches something (how-to, tutorials)                               |
| Animation video   | Animated visuals for complex or abstract topics                     |
| Brand video       | Tells the brand story, values                                       |
| Testimonial video | Real customers share their experience - builds trust                |
| Demo video        | Shows how the product works                                         |
| 360° video        | Viewer looks around in all directions (tours, real estate, travel)  |
| AR video          | Augmented reality - e.g. virtual try-on, see furniture in your room |

##### Best practices in video marketing

- Hook the viewer in the **first 3-5 seconds**; keep it short.
- Add **subtitles** (many watch without sound); mobile-first / vertical format.
- Clear **call to action** and branding; good audio and quality.
- Optimise title, description, tags and thumbnail for search.
- Post consistently and **measure** views, watch time, engagement.

#### 4.4 Video marketing for a brand

★ **W2025 Q4(c) [7M: choose a brand, how it uses video marketing for a new product, at least two video formats]**

**Brand chosen: Nike** - launching a new running shoe 'AirRun X'.

**Objective:** create awareness before launch and generate sales after launch.

| Video format                                        | Platform                      | Idea                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1. Teaser / short-form video (Reels, Shorts)</b> | Instagram, YouTube Shorts     | 15-30 second teasers showing the shoe in motion with a countdown and hashtag #RunWithAirRunX; hook in first 3 seconds |
| <b>2. Product demo video</b>                        | YouTube, website product page | Shows cushioning, grip and weight, tested by runners; ends with 'Buy now' link                                        |
| <b>3. Testimonial video</b>                         | Facebook, Instagram           | Athletes and regular runners share their experience                                                                   |
| <b>4. 360° / AR video</b>                           | Website, app                  | Customer rotates the shoe in 360° or tries it virtually                                                               |

##### Plan

1. Pre-launch teasers → launch demo and brand film → post-launch testimonials and user videos.
2. Share on YouTube, Instagram, Facebook; run **video ads** to a targeted audience (runners, age 18-35).
3. Add subtitles, clear CTA and link to buy.

4. Track views, watch time, CTR and sales; improve next videos.

## 4.4 Video and engagement

### ★ W2025 Q4(b)OR [4M: how video content enhances engagement on social platforms]

1. **Grabs attention** quickly with moving visuals and sound - more eye-catching than text.
2. **Higher likes, comments and shares**; people share entertaining or useful videos.
3. **Conveys message faster** and is remembered longer; shows emotion and personality.
4. **Platform algorithms favour video** (Reels, Shorts), giving more reach.
5. **Interactive formats** - live videos, polls, Q&A - allow real-time conversation.
6. **Longer time spent** and builds trust (testimonials, demos), leading to more conversions.

## Last-minute revision sheet - Unit 4

- Meta ads: carousel, story, lead generation, video.
- Insights: reach, impressions, engagement, profile visits, followers, demographics.
- Twitter ads: promoted tweets, promoted accounts, promoted trends.
- Video types: explainer, educational, animation, brand, testimonial, demo, 360°, AR.
- Video best practices: hook in 3 seconds, subtitles, CTA, mobile-first.